
Appendix A. Printer Characteristics

Some printers may not be able to print your output as designed. This appendix describes some of the printer characteristics, such as pel density and Single Byte (SBCS) and Double Byte (DBCS) Character Set support, that may affect the printout. For more information about printer characteristics, refer to the *Advanced Function Printing: Printer Information*, or appropriate documentation for your printer.

Supported Printers

Refer to *IBM Printing Systems: Printer Information*, (S544–5750), for more information about which IBM Advanced Function Printers are supported. For additional information, also refer to the IBM printers web page at <http://www.ibm.com/printers>.

Printable Area

Different printers have different printable areas. The printable area also depends on the paper size and the degree of rotation specified for the page layout or overlay used.

You should specify the *Offset* prompt on the Define Overlay Specifications display or the Define PFD Specifications display so that your printout fits within the printable area of your printer.

For information about the printable areas refer to the *IBM Printing Systems: Printer Information*, (S544–5750), or appropriate documentation for your printer.

Printer Storage Limitations

The data needed to print your printout is loaded into printer storage. With an unusually complex printout, the storage requirements may approach or exceed the storage limitations of the printer. If the storage limitations are exceeded, the printout will not be printed. If the storage used is close to the limitations, printing may be slowed somewhat.

In such cases, you should consider simplifying your printout in one or more of the following ways:

- Reduce the number of elements
- Reduce the number of fonts
- Reduce the number of page segments
- Reduce the number of graphics
- Avoid use of shading
- Avoid use of dotted and dashed lines or boxes
- Avoid use of enlarged or reduced characters
- Use smaller fonts

You should also consider purchasing more raster image storage for your printer if this is appropriate.